

Facilitator Guide

For facilitators running the Studio build-along. This is the deepest session — orchestration, topics, tools, evaluations, channels — the agent moves from 'answers questions' to 'takes governed actions'.

Session at a glance

Tier	Microsoft Copilot Studio — full agent build
Session length	120 minutes (90 build, 20 evaluate & publish, 10 Q&A)
Audience	Makers, IT pros, citizen developers, line-of-business architects
Group size	Webinar — no participant cap; strong chat moderation recommended
Format	Webinar build-along — each participant builds one full Studio agent end-to-end live on the call
Deliverable	A published, governed agent ready for tenant-internal use

What this session unlocks

This is where Copilot stops being chat and becomes infrastructure. Participants leave understanding orchestration, knowledge, topics, tools, evaluation, and channel publishing — and the language to talk to IT and compliance about deployment.

Prerequisites — confirm before the session

- Every participant has access to copilotstudio.microsoft.com with a maker licence
- A default environment with Dataverse provisioned (or a shared dev environment)
- The six sample Excel data files distributed before the session
- Power Automate access for the tool step (or pre-built shared flows participants can reference)
- Admin approval lead time understood for any Teams or M365 Copilot channel publish
- You have personally built each of the six agents in the same environment the participants will use

Materials checklist

- The six Copilot Studio build-along PDFs (5 pages each)
- The six Excel data files in a shared link
- Pre-built Power Automate flows (or stubs) for the tool step
- This facilitator guide and a visible timer
- A backup environment with a fully-built reference agent for live demo

Success criteria

- Every participant publishes their agent (even to a private channel)
- Every participant runs one evaluation and reads the three scores
- Every participant triggers a tool call and sees the side-effect (Teams card, list row, etc.)
- At least one participant says aloud the words 'orchestration', 'topic', and 'tool' in the right meanings

Agenda & Timing

Block-by-block plan. Run the clock visibly — participants build faster when they can see the pace.

Time	Block	Talk track / Action
00:00 - 00:05	Open & frame	Studio sits above the Chat / paid tiers. Today: orchestration, tools, evaluations, channels.
00:05 - 00:20	Create agent + orchestration mode	Walk the Generative vs Classic decision. Pick Generative for the build.
00:20 - 00:35	Knowledge + Instructions	Upload Excel, paste instructions. Same pattern as paid tier, deeper context.
00:35 - 00:50	Custom topic	Build one topic from the PDF. This is where intent → flow becomes visible.
00:50 - 01:10	Tool step (Power Automate or connector)	Wire one tool. The first time the agent does something is the moment that lands.
01:10 - 01:20	Settings (auth, DLP, content moderation)	Walk the four settings panes. Auth as Microsoft is the default to set.
01:20 - 01:35	Evaluations + Test pane	Create one eval set with three items. Run it. Read the scores together.
01:35 - 01:45	Publish to a channel	Publish to a personal Teams channel or in-product preview. Real users come later.
01:45 - 01:55	Q&A and 'where next'	Cover Cowork as the action-on-schedule companion to Studio agents.
01:55 - 02:00	Close	Restate the four-tier story. Land the homework: bring one tool idea to next session.

Pacing tip

The tool step is the highest-friction step in the entire four-tier programme. Pre-build the Power Automate flow as a template participants import — do NOT have a webinar full of people wire a flow from scratch in 20 minutes. Focus their time on the AGENT side of the tool: name, description, inputs, outcome.

Facilitator Notes — Step by Step

What to say, what to do, and what to watch for at each build step.

1 Create agent + pick environment

Say: Studio agents live in a Power Platform environment — that's where governance starts.

Do: Open copilotstudio.microsoft.com → Create. Confirm correct environment for the room.

Watch for: Wrong environment = no Dataverse, no connector access. Confirm first, then build.

2 Choose orchestration mode

Say: Generative reasons about intent; Classic fires on trigger phrases. Today: Generative.

Do: Settings → Generative AI → Orchestration: Generative. Note Classic exists.

Watch for: Some participants will want Classic because it 'feels safer'. Use the PDF compare table to explain when each fits.

3 Add knowledge

Say: Same pattern as paid tier — but Studio agents can layer SharePoint, Dataverse, web.

Do: Knowledge → Add knowledge → File. Upload the sample Excel.

Watch for: Knowledge ingest can take a few minutes the first time — keep them busy with the next step.

4 Paste instructions

Say: Instructions guide the model regardless of orchestration mode — they're the rules of engagement.

Do: Overview → Instructions. Paste from the PDF.

Watch for: Length matters less than clarity. Bullet rules beat paragraphs every time.

5 Add a custom topic

Say: Topics are reusable flows the agent can call when intent matches. This is your first deliberate flow.

Do: Topics → Add a topic → Create from description. Use the PDF spec.

Watch for: Description-driven topic creation can produce weird steps — review and trim before saving.

Facilitator Notes — Continued

Final build steps, common blockers, and how to keep the room engaged.

6 Add a tool

Say: Tools let the agent ACT — update CRM, file a ticket, send a card. This is where Copilot becomes useful.

Do: Tools → Add a tool. Use the pre-built Power Automate flow from the shared link.

Watch for: If the connector needs authentication, set it **BEFORE** the room starts. Auth prompts derail pacing.

7 Configure settings

Say: Four panes, four decisions: name, AI mode, auth, security. Skip any and you're flying blind in production.

Do: Walk Settings → General / Generative AI / Authentication / Security.

Watch for: Authenticate with Microsoft must be **ON** for the tool to act as the user.

8 Build an evaluation set

Say: Evaluations make agent quality measurable. Without these, you can't tell if you broke anything.

Do: Analytics → Evaluations → New. Paste the three items from the PDF. Run it.

Watch for: Eval needs the test set to actually match real questions — coach them on this.

9 Test in the Test pane + Activity map

Say: The Activity map shows EXACTLY what happened — every topic, tool, citation. Use it.

Do: Run two test prompts. Open Activity map. Share your screen and walk through one trace end-to-end.

Watch for: First-timers ignore the Activity map. It's the most useful debug surface — call it out explicitly and have them open theirs.

10 Publish to a channel

Say: Publish is the start of real-user feedback. Start small — a personal Teams channel is plenty.

Do: Publish → Channels → Microsoft Teams (or Demo website for sandbox).

Watch for: Teams and M365 Copilot channels need **ADMIN** approval — set expectations on timeline.

Engagement prompts

Engagement prompts (use when energy drops)

- Who triggered the tool? Show the Teams card / list row / record it created.
- Who broke the agent intentionally? Read the failure to the room — failures are gold.
- Look at your Activity map — did orchestration pick the topic you expected? Why / why not?
- If you were going to ship this to 50 users tomorrow — what would you tighten first?

Common Blockers & Q&A Bank

The questions you will be asked. Have these crisp.

Common blockers (and your fix)

- **Environment doesn't have Dataverse**

→ Use the default environment, or have admin enable Dataverse before the session.

- **Power Automate flow fails on first call**

→ Connection authentication. Re-authenticate the connector inside the flow, save, retry.

- **Generative orchestration picks the wrong topic**

→ Topic trigger phrases too vague. Tighten the description and add specific trigger examples.

- **Evaluation scores are all 'low'**

→ Test set inputs don't match the agent's actual scope. Rewrite the inputs to be realistic.

- **Publish to Teams blocked**

→ Tenant admin approval needed for Teams channel. Park it; publish to Demo website for the live build.

- **Authentication keeps prompting in the test pane**

→ Authenticate with Microsoft toggle missed in Settings. Turn it on and retest.

Top participant questions

Q: Difference between Studio and Agent Builder?

A: Studio gives you topics, tools, channels, evaluations, full Dataverse access, and governed publishing. Agent Builder is great for grounded Q&A — Studio is for grounded ACTION.

Q: Does this need IT or admin involvement?

A: Building doesn't. Publishing to enterprise channels (Teams, M365 Copilot) requires admin approval. Plan that into your rollout.

Q: Can I connect to ServiceNow / Jira / SAP / etc.?

A: Yes — through connectors, custom HTTP, or MCP servers. The build-along uses Power Automate because everyone has it.

Q: How do I version or roll back?

A: Solutions in Power Platform. Treat your agent like an application: solution → ALM → environments.

Q: Where does evaluation data live?

A: Inside your environment. Run evaluations before and after every change to catch regressions.

Top participant questions — continued

Q: When would I choose Classic orchestration?

A: Compliance-critical or tightly-scoped flows where you need every conversational step to be deterministic and auditable.

Q: Does the agent inherit user permissions automatically?

A: Yes when 'Authenticate with Microsoft' is on — the tool calls run as the signed-in user, so Dataverse RLS and SharePoint permissions apply.

Tier Comparison & Per-Function Reference

Use this to answer 'why this tier, not another?' and to tailor language by function.

When to use which Copilot tier

Tier	Best for	Time to value	Governance
Free Copilot Chat	Pure-instruction agents anyone can build, no data upload	5 minutes	Tenant policies apply; no extra data residency to consider
Paid M365 Copilot	Add your own knowledge (Excel, docs) for grounded answers	15 minutes	Stays inside the tenant; admin governs sharing
Copilot Studio	Full agents with topics, tools, orchestration, evaluations, channels	Hours to days	Solution-managed; DLP, RLS, Entra auth, audit trail
Copilot Cowork	Task-driven recurring work using your live M365 surfaces	10 minutes	Acts as the signed-in user; consent and review-before-send patterns

Per-function quick reference

HR — People Ops Copilot

FOCUS

Self-service leave booking via Power Automate + workforce insights for HR.

WATCH FOR

Row-level security on the workbook is non-negotiable in prod.

IT — Service Desk Copilot

FOCUS

ServiceNow ticket creation tool; password self-service flow.

WATCH FOR

Authenticate with Microsoft = clean audit trail in ServiceNow.

Sales — Pipeline Copilot

FOCUS

Dataverse opportunity update tool; weighted forecast queries.

WATCH FOR

Dataverse security roles must scope sellers to their own book.

Finance — Budget Copilot

FOCUS

Variance note submission via Power Automate to SharePoint + Teams card.

WATCH FOR

Manager approval on amounts above threshold.

CS — Insights Copilot

FOCUS

Dynamics 365 case escalation tool with structured reason.

WATCH FOR

Business unit security in D365 keeps regions separate.

Marketing — Campaigns Copilot

FOCUS

Planner task creation for campaign brief intake.

WATCH FOR

Region scoping on knowledge so marketers see only their region.

Closing

Studio is where Copilot becomes a real platform inside your tenant.

Closing talk track

Restate the four-tier ladder. Studio is industrial — built once, governed, used by hundreds.

Homework: identify ONE tool the agent could call in their real job. Bring it to the next session.

Tease Cowork: 'Studio agents answer when called. Cowork agents work on a schedule. Together: a real teammate.'